ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME — SOCIAL SCIENCE · CLASS 8 · SET 03

Max. Marks: 60 · The Mastermind Coaching Classes, Jaipur · Alternate correct points / examples to be given full credit

SECTION A — Multiple Choice Questions (1×15=15) — 15 marks

Question 1 · Choose the correct option for each sub-part.

1.(i) Fill in the blank with the appropriate option.
A part of Nature becomes a resource only if it is technologically accessible, economically feasible and ..... .

(A) politically popular (B) available in every country
(C) culturally acceptable (D) renewable within a year

> **Ans: (C)** The three conditions: technologically accessible, economically feasible, culturally acceptable.

(ii) The Kaveri river is shared by Karnataka, Tamil Nadu, Kerala and —

(A) Andhra Pradesh (B) Puducherry (C) Goa (D) Telangana

> **Ans: (B)** Sharing of such rivers needs negotiation and careful management.

(iii) Arrange the following events in chronological order and select the correct option.

1. Battle of Haldighati
2. Re-establishment of the Mewar Kingdom
3. Battle of Talikota
4. Timur's invasion of Delhi

(A) 2, 4, 3, 1 (B) 4, 2, 3, 1 (C) 2, 3, 4, 1 (D) 2, 4, 1, 3

> **Ans: (A)** Correct order: Re-establishment of the Mewar Kingdom (1326) → Timur's invasion of Delhi (1398) → Battle of Talikota (1565) → Battle of Haldighati (1576)

(iv) Which queen of the Garha kingdom died fighting a general sent by Akbar in 1564?

(A) Rani Durgavati (B) Rani Abbakka
(C) Tarabai (D) Ahilyabai Holkar

> **Ans: (A)** Rani Durgavati ruled a Gond kingdom in central India and took her own life to avoid capture.

(v) Which Mughal emperor re-imposed the jizya that Akbar had abolished?

(A) Jahangir (B) Aurangzeb (C) Shah Jahan (D) Humayun

> **Ans: (B)** Aurangzeb also reimposed a pilgrimage tax on Hindus.

(vi) In which language was the inscription on Chhatrapati Shivaji's seal written, in a departure from the prevailing Persian seals?

(A) Arabic (B) Urdu (C) Sanskrit (D) English

> **Ans: (C)** It was part of his vision of Swarajya.

(vii) Shivaji conceded defeat and signed the Treaty of Purandar with the Mughal general —

(A) Shaista Khan (B) Afzal Khan (C) Dara Shikoh (D) Jai Singh

> **Ans: (D)** Aurangzeb had sent the Rajput general Jai Singh.

(viii) Given below are two statements – Assertion (A) and Reason (R). Read them and select the correct option.
Assertion (A): The British victory at the Battle of Plassey (1757) owed much to conspiracy.
Reason (R): Mir Jafar, commander of most of the Nawab's army, stood aside during the battle.

(A) A is correct, R is incorrect
(B) A is incorrect, R is correct
(C) Both A and R are correct and R is the correct explanation of A
(D) Both A and R are correct but R is not the correct explanation of A

> **Ans: (C)** Clive had promised to install Mir Jafar as Nawab in return for betrayal.

(ix) Fill in the blank with the appropriate option.
The destruction of the Vedapurishwaran temple at Pondicherry in 1748 was ordered by the French Governor-General .....

(A) Clive (B) Lord Wellesley (C) Dupleix (D) Marthanda Varma

> **Ans: (C)** It was a rare French exception to non-interference in religion.

(x) Read Statement I and Statement II and select the correct option.
Statement I: The Great Famine of 1876–78 caused the death of up to 8 million Indians, mostly in the Deccan plateau.
Statement II: Grain continued to be exported from India during the years of this famine.

(A) Only I is correct (B) Only II is correct
(C) Both are correct (D) Both are incorrect

> **Ans: (C)** Both are correct; about one million tonnes of rice per year were exported.

(xi) The Election Commission of India was established in —

(A) 1950 (B) 1947 (C) 1951 (D) 1962

> **Ans: (A)** The first general elections were held in 1951–52.

(xii) Which Chief Election Commissioner (1990) is associated with voter ID cards and strict watch on election spending?

(A) Sukumar Sen (B) S.Y. Quraishi (C) N. Gopalaswami (D) T.N. Seshan

> **Ans: (D)** T.N. Seshan's reforms made campaign rules precise and introduced voter IDs.

(xiii) On which of the following lists can ONLY the Union Government make laws?

(A) State List (B) Union List (C) Concurrent List (D) Local List

> **Ans: (B)** On the Concurrent List both can legislate, with Union law prevailing.

(xiv) Which of these states has a bicameral (two-House) legislature?

(A) Rajasthan (B) Maharashtra (C) Punjab (D) Kerala

> **Ans: (B)** Bicameral states: Andhra Pradesh, Bihar, Karnataka, Maharashtra, Telangana and Uttar Pradesh.

(xv) SWAYAM, an Indian platform mentioned as an enabler of production and skills, offers —

(A) crop insurance (B) bank loans
(C) weather forecasts (D) online courses (MOOCs)

> **Ans: (D)** SWAYAM offers MOOCs for Grade 9 and above; the National Career Service is a job portal.

SECTION B — Very Short Answer Questions (4×2=8) — 8 marks

Question Nos. 2 to 5 · each carries 2 marks · at least 20 words.

2.(A) What is meant by 'stewardship' of natural resources?

> **Marking points (1 + 1):**
> - Respecting Nature and using resources wisely — 1 mark
> - So that renewables can restore and regenerate, and non-renewables are used responsibly and judiciously — 1 mark

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2.(B) 'Nature ignores political boundaries.' Explain with the example of the Kaveri river.

> **Marking points (1 + 1):**
> - Natural resources are shared across states/countries — 1 mark
> - The Kaveri flows through Karnataka, Tamil Nadu, Kerala and Puducherry; sharing needs negotiation and careful management to keep peace — 1 mark

3. List any two subjects of the State List.

> **Marking points (any two, 1 mark each):**
> - Any two (1 mark each): police; public health; public order; agriculture; local government (accept other correct subjects of the State List).

4. Give any two reasons why European powers colonised other regions.

> **Marking points (any two, 1 mark each):**
> - Political competition — race for territory and global influence
> - Economic gain — resources, markets, trade routes
> - Religion — spreading Christianity
> - Scientific inquiry — exploring unknown lands (any two, 1 mark each)

5.(A) Differentiate between the Governor and the Chief Minister of a state.

> **Marking points (1 + 1):**
> - Governor — constitutional head of the state, appointed by the President — 1 mark
> - Chief Minister — de facto executive head, leader of the majority in the Vidhan Sabha, selects the Council of Ministers — 1 mark

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5.(B) What is Question Hour? Why is it important?

> **Marking points (1 + 1):**
> - A period in which MPs ask ministers questions about policies and activities — 1 mark
> - It makes the Executive accountable to the Legislature — 1 mark

SECTION C — Short Answer Questions (2×3=6) — 6 marks

Question Nos. 6 and 7 · each carries 3 marks · about 40–60 words.

6.(A) Describe any three features of the resistance of Rani Durgavati against Akbar's army.

> **Marking points (any three, 1 mark each):**
> - Ruler of the Garha kingdom (a Gond kingdom of central India); governed wisely
> - Kept an army of 20,000 soldiers and 1,000 elephants and repelled several invasions
> - In 1564, she fought bravely against a general sent by Akbar though outnumbered and outmatched
> - Wounded, she took her own life to avoid capture; she was only 40

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6.(B) Explain any three features of the rule of Muhammad bin Tughlaq.

Marking points (any three, 1 mark each):

- Expanded the Sultanate — for the first time since the Mauryas most of the Subcontinent was under one ruler
- Shifted the capital from Delhi to Daulatabad; people forced to travel over 1,000 km; plan failed
- Introduced token currency — copper coins with value of silver/gold; led to counterfeiting and decline
- Both experiments caused great loss of life and economic damage

7.(A) Describe in three points how Shivaji escaped from Agra.

Marking points (any three, 1 mark each):

- Insulted at Aurangzeb's court, he stormed out and was placed under house arrest
- He began sending big baskets of fruit and sweets to holy men and Mughal generals; guards first checked, then stopped checking
- Shivaji and his son Sambhaji hid in the baskets and escaped; Aurangzeb never captured him again

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7.(B) Explain any three features of the trade networks of the Marathas.

Marking points (any three, 1 mark each):

- Shivaji encouraged trade and personally took part in maritime trade; he and his officials owned ships
- Ports reached included Mocha (Yemen), Muscat (Oman) and Malacca (Malaysia); cargo included gold and textiles
- Roads were built and maintained
- Ferries and bridges supported river transport (e.g. in Odisha in the 18th century)

SECTION D — Long Answer Questions (2×5=10) — 10 marks

Question Nos. 8 and 9 · each carries 5 marks · about 80–100 words.

8.(A) Explain the activities of the Portuguese in India. Mention any five points.

Marking points (any five, 1 mark each):

- Vasco da Gama reached Kappad near Kozhikode (Kerala) in 1498
- Behaved aggressively — seized, tortured and killed Indian merchants; bombarded Calicut
- Captured Goa (1510), the capital of their Indian colony
- Cartaz system — ships in the Arabian Sea had to buy Portuguese permits or be seized
- Monopolised the spice trade between India and Europe for nearly a century
- Inquisition in Goa (1560) — forced conversions, persecution, destruction of Hindu temples; resisted by Rani Abbakka

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8.(B) Explain the effects of the famines during British rule. Mention any five points.

Marking points (any five, 1 mark each):

- Bengal Famine of 1770–72 killed nearly one-third of Bengal's population (about 10 million)
- Great Famine of 1876–78 — up to 8 million perished; grain exports continued
- Harsh revenue targets and even higher taxes were maintained during famines
- Relief camps were too few with inadequate supplies; 'free market' policy worsened the crisis
- Estimates of total famine deaths under British rule range from 50 to 100 million
- Rural India sank into deep poverty and never recovered

9. Differentiate between the Lok Sabha and the Rajya Sabha on the basis of five points.

Marking points (any five, 1 mark each):

- Lok Sabha — House of the People/Lower House; Rajya Sabha — Council of States/Upper House
- Lok Sabha — directly elected by the people; Rajya Sabha — indirectly elected by MLAs (233) plus 12 nominated by the President
- Lok Sabha — five-year term; Rajya Sabha — permanent house, six-year term, one-third retire every two years
- Lok Sabha presided over by the Speaker; Rajya Sabha chaired by the Vice President
- Money Bills can be introduced only in the Lok Sabha
- Council of Ministers is collectively responsible to the Lok Sabha

SECTION E — Case / Source Based Questions (4×4=16) — 16 marks

Question Nos. 10 to 13 · each carries 4 marks (1+1+2).

10. Read the paragraph given below and answer the questions that follow: (1+1+2=4)

Pema's family farm was in trouble. Yields were falling and the cost of chemical fertilisers and pesticides kept her family in debt. They switched to compost, pest repellents made from neem and garlic, and growing several crops across the year. After about five years the farm thrived, selling cardamom, ginger and traditional vegetables at premium prices. In 2016, the whole state of Sikkim became 100 per cent organic, and farmers' incomes grew by about 20 per cent on average.

(10.1) In which year did Sikkim become a 100 per cent organic state?

2016.

(10.2) Name one natural pest repellent used by Pema's family.

Neem (or garlic).

(10.3) Explain any two benefits Sikkim gained by going organic.

Any two (1 mark each): local biodiversity flourished; tourism increased; farmers' incomes rose by about 20%; farmers escaped debt from chemical inputs; became a global model.

11. Read the paragraph given below and answer the questions that follow: (1+1+2=4)

Rana Kumbha, a 15th-century ruler of Mewar in present-day Rajasthan, resisted the later Sultanates. He built Kumbhalgarh Fort on a ridge of the Aravalli hills. Its massive wall, about 36 km long, is one of the longest continuous walls in the world. Hill forts like this were difficult for enemies to attack and sheltered armies in times of danger.

(11.1) Which fort was built by Rana Kumbha in the Aravalli hills?

Kumbhalgarh Fort.

(11.2) How long is the wall of this fort?

About 36 km.

(11.3) Explain how hill forts helped rulers to resist invasions.

(1) Their height and strong walls made them difficult to attack; (1) they sheltered armies and people and helped control strategic routes, supporting guerrilla warfare.

12. Read the paragraph given below and answer the questions that follow: (1+1+2=4)

> Rani Abbakka I ruled Ullal in present-day southern Karnataka. She formed alliances and thwarted Portuguese attempts to take her land. She was captured and died fighting in prison. Her successor, Rani Abbakka II, made fireballs out of coconut shells and set Portuguese ships on fire. Their stories are remembered through the folk art of Yakshagana.

(12.1) Which territory did Rani Abbakka I rule?

> Ullal (southern Karnataka).

(12.2) What weapon did Rani Abbakka II create to attack Portuguese ships?

> Fireballs made from coconut shells.

(12.3) How does this example show that Indians resisted European powers from the very beginning?

> (1) Local rulers, including women, fought the Portuguese with alliances and ingenious weapons; (1) their memory survives in folk traditions such as Yakshagana.

13. Read the paragraph given below and answer the questions that follow: (1+1+2=4)

> India has a young population — about 65 per cent of Indians are below the age of 35. This offers a 'demographic dividend', but only if the young are healthy, educated and skilled. At present, adult literacy is about 85 per cent for males and 70 per cent for females, so there is still work to be done. Online platforms such as SWAYAM and the National Career Service help young people learn and find jobs.

(13.1) What percentage of India's population is below the age of 35?

> About 65 per cent.

(13.2) What is meant by 'demographic dividend' in this passage?

> The economic advantage a country gets from having a large young working-age population.

(13.3) What must be done to convert India's young population into valuable human capital? Give two points.

> Any two (1 mark each): quality education; healthcare; training and skilling; use of technology/online platforms; narrowing the gender gap in literacy.

SECTION F — Map Based Question (1×5=5) — 5 marks

Question No. 14 · 5 marks.

14. On the Political outline Map of India provided, locate and label any **five** of the following places using appropriate symbols/signs: (5×1=5)

(I) Surat
(II) Haldighati
(III) Talikota
(IV) Korba coal field
(V) Kolar gold field
(VI) Kozhikode (Calicut)

The following questions are for Visually Impaired students only, in lieu of Question No. 14. Answer any five questions:

(I) In which present-day Indian state/UT is Surat located? 1
(II) In which present-day Indian state/UT is Haldighati located? 1
(III) In which present-day Indian state/UT is Talikota located? 1
(IV) In which present-day Indian state/UT is Korba coal field located? 1
(V) In which present-day Indian state/UT is Kolar gold field located? 1
(VI) In which present-day Indian state/UT is Kozhikode located? 1

1 mark for each correctly located and labelled place (any five); a position within about 150 km of the true location is acceptable. For Visually Impaired candidates: 1 mark for each correct state/UT (any five).

- (I) Surat — **Gujarat**
- (II) Haldighati — **Rajasthan**
- (III) Talikota — **Karnataka**
- (IV) Korba coal field — **Chhattisgarh**
- (V) Kolar gold field — **Karnataka**
- (VI) Kozhikode (Calicut) — **Kerala**

